



Samsung NP300E5Z-A0N

here comes the big question: Do you really need a laptop that can work up to eight hours? Obviously, the answer is a big 'No'!

In reality, a laptop delivers only about 75 per cent of the battery life claimed by its manufacturer. If you are aiming for a large-screen laptop, make sure it has up to four hours of battery life. If you plan to use your laptop a lot on the move, get one that runs at least 5-6 hours on a single charge.

Operating system

As you scroll down the specification-sheet of a laptop, you may come across the words 'Free DOS' written next to the operating system (OS) option. Alongside offering preloaded editions of Microsoft Windows in their laptops, more and more companies are leaving the choice of OS to the consumers these days.

A good tip is to prioritise the desired configuration and install an Open Source OS such as Ubuntu and OpenSUSE. This will easily save you those extra thousands of rupees in the overall laptop price. However, if you are a die-hard Windows user, an Open Source OS may not meet your

expectations in terms of functionality and user comfort.

Brand

There are companies that offer discounts every now and then to lure the customers and then there are those that maintain a fixed price. Nevertheless, choosing a trusted brand has its own long-term benefits. It might be pretty expensive but putting your faith on that decade-old brand will not go in vain.

Thanks to clever marketing and branding tactics, nowadays every brand seems trustworthy. Digging the Internet and doing some market research will take some considerable time for the average Joe to unearth the real truth behind the cloak. A good tip is research about the company, its background and the number of service centres it has in the city. Also, find out their service charges and availability of spare parts.

Last but not the least, ensure you have the laptop's warranty in written and you understand every single word of the warranty and replacement policy before you leave the showroom with that 'extra carton' in your hand. ●

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